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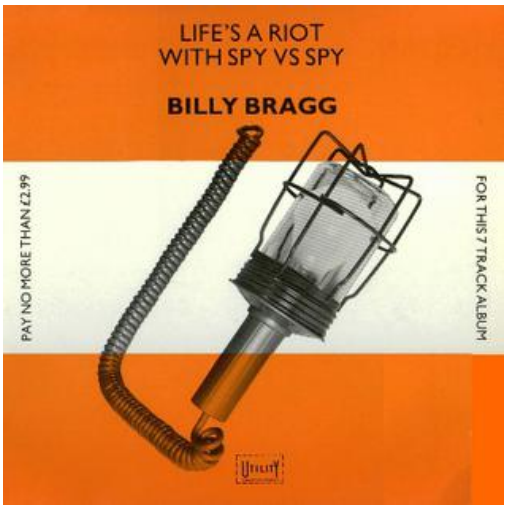
Life's a Riot with Spy vs Spy

Life's a Riot with Spy vs Spy is the debut album by English singer-songwriter Billy Bragg, released on 1 July 1983 by the Charisma Records imprint Utility.[1]

All songs on the original album consisted of Bragg singing to his electric guitar accompaniment. The album contains both politically charged songs, such as the attack on the school system and unemployment, "To Have and to Have Not", and love songs such as "The Milkman of Human Kindness" and "A New England" (which was later a hit for singer Kirsty MacColl).

The original album played at 45 rpm rather than the more usual 33⅓ rpm, contained only seven songs, and lasted for only 15 minutes and 57 seconds. However, rather than being classified as an EP, it qualified for the UK Albums Chart due to its total number of tracks meeting the rules and reached number 30 in March 1985.[2][3]

Life's a Riot with Spy vs Spy



Studio album by Billy Bragg

Released	1 July 1983
Recorded	2–4 February 1983
Studios	Chappell, Park Street, Mayfair, London
Genres	British folk rock · folk punk
Length	15:57
Labels	Utility · Go! Discs (November 1983)
Producer	Oliver Hitch

Billy Bragg chronology

Life's a Riot with Spy vs Spy (1983)	*Brewing Up with Billy Bragg* (1984)

Background

The seven tracks on *Life's a Riot with Spy vs Spy* were recorded from 2 to 4 February 1983 at Chappell Music's demo studio on Park Street, under the supervision of in-house producer Oliver Hitch.[4][5] The album was recorded straight to tape, with no mixing undertaken.[6]

The title of the album alludes to Bragg's pseudonym of Spy vs Spy which he used when busking prior to his recording career, and which in turn comes from the strip of the same name in *Mad* magazine.[7]

Versions

Life's a Riot with Spy vs Spy was released by Utility Records, a newly founded imprint of Charisma